
DIGITAL SAT

Reading & Writing — Grammar / Conventions

150 Practice Questions

All passages, names, studies, and data are original. Modeled on 2024–2026 DSAT style, stems, and trap patterns.

Difficulty Key

■ Easy (~30%)

■ Medium (~40%)

■ Hard (~30%)

Q1. [Easy]

In the damp hollows of the southern Appalachians, the fungus *Panellus stipticus* emits a faint green light after _____ hikers sometimes mistake the glow for distant lanterns.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) dark,
- B) dark
- C) dark.
- D) dark; and

Q2. [Easy]

The murals of painter Alma Reyes Cortés, celebrated for their layered depictions of market life in Oaxaca, _____ now housed in three museums across southern Mexico.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) are
- B) is
- C) was
- D) has been

Q3. [Easy]

Novelist Perpetua Andrade published her story collection *The Tin Orchard* in 1954. Decades later, in 2003, a stage adaptation _____ its premiere at a small theater in Wellington, New Zealand.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) made
- B) makes
- C) will make
- D) is making

Q4. [Easy]

Rising above the salt flats of the Pampilla basin in Chile's Atacama Desert, the Torre Blanca outcrop is composed largely of ulexite, a soft mineral that _____ delicate fibrous crystals under slow evaporation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) forming
 - B) to form
 - C) forms
 - D) having formed
-

Q5. [Easy]

Under the 2019 groundwater accord in the fictional Serena Valley, each participating village submitted _____ own water-use records to a regional review board before any new wells could be approved.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its
- B) their
- C) it's
- D) they're

Q6. [Easy]

Perched at 4,100 meters on a ridge with famously stable air, the Cerro Lumen Observatory owes _____ exceptionally sharp images less to its telescopes than to the thin, dry atmosphere above them.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its
- B) it's
- C) its'
- D) their

Q7. [Easy]

Why do some desert wildflowers bloom only once after decades of _____ answer lies in seed coatings that dissolve solely under rare, sustained rainfall.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) dormancy, the
- B) dormancy. The
- C) dormancy? The
- D) dormancy the

Q8. [Easy]

The handwritten recipes, along with a set of annotated banquet menus, _____ donated to the culinary archive at Halloway College in 1998 by the family of chef Odile Ferrant.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) were
 - B) was
 - C) is
 - D) has been
-

Q9. [Easy]

Every spring, the gray cranes of the Vesle Marsh _____ to the same nesting hummocks, guided, researchers suspect, by landmarks memorized during their first migration.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) return
- B) has returned
- C) will have returned
- D) returning

Q10. [Medium]

The legacy of the Portuguese Empire, which once linked ports on four continents, remains audible in Portuguese-speaking Brazil. Contrast Brazil with the trading post of Hirado, Japan, whose commercial ties to Portugal were severed in _____ the latter's connection to the empire is now so faint that Portuguese is rarely heard there today.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 1639,
- B) 1639 and
- C) 1639:
- D) 1639

Q11. [Medium]

The clavilyre—a nineteenth-century hybrid of zither and hammered _____ was assembled by Belgian instrument maker Henriette Doorn from parts salvaged from two damaged concert instruments.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) dulcimer—
 - B) dulcimer,
 - C) dulcimer;
 - D) dulcimer:
-

Q12. [Medium]

According to a five-year monitoring effort, the concentration of microplastic particles in the deepest sediments of Lake Verian _____ risen even as surface concentrations have declined, suggesting that fragments settle faster than they degrade.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) has
- B) have
- C) are
- D) were

Q13. [Hard]

As part of her effort to chart undiscovered hydrothermal fields in the fictional Meridian Trench, oceanographer Talia Brandt deployed a towed sonar platform. The vessel _____ the seafloor, which harbored vent systems first detected only a decade earlier, followed transects that guaranteed a mapped corridor two kilometers wide on every pass.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) surveyed
- B) was surveying
- C) surveying
- D) surveys

Q14. [Medium]

Between 2011 and 2016, textile artist Rosalind Mbeki completed three residencies at coastal studios in Mozambique, Portugal, and Wales. During _____ residencies, she produced the woven triptychs that later anchored her first retrospective.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) this
- B) that
- C) these
- D) one

Q15. [Medium]

In a 2021 field study, biologists Mara Okafor and Liesl Van Dyk tracked seed dispersal by fruit bats across a fragmented forest reserve. The _____ findings indicated that bats carried viable seeds nearly twice as far as earlier models had predicted.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) researchers'
- B) researcher's
- C) researchers
- D) researchers's

Q16. [Medium]

Determined to reduce spoilage during the humid harvest months, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the cooperative's engineers redesigned the village's cold-storage sheds around passive ventilation.
- B) the village's cold-storage sheds were redesigned around passive ventilation by the cooperative's engineers.
- C) redesigning the cold-storage sheds around passive ventilation was the approach the cooperative's engineers took.
- D) the cold-storage sheds' redesign around passive ventilation was carried out by the cooperative's engineers.

Q17. [Medium]

The Shorebird Stewards program trains volunteers to monitor plover nests along the estuary, log hatch dates in a shared database, and _____ predators by installing low wire exclosures around vulnerable clutches.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) deter
- B) deterring
- C) deterred
- D) to have deterred

Q18. [Medium]

Coastal grain mills in northwestern France adopted turbine power unusually early; the Landry mill in Brittany installed its first turbine in _____ whereas inland mills, lacking reliable river access, waited decades to modernize.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 1873, for instance;
- B) 1873, for instance,
- C) 1873; for instance,
- D) 1873, for instance:

Q19. [Medium]

With sustained gradients exceeding 20 percent near its summit, the Passo di Vellei is one alpine _____ amateur cyclists frequently underestimate, especially in early spring, when meltwater slicks the switchbacks.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) climb in which,
- B) climb that
- C) climb, which
- D) climb, that

Q20. [Medium]

By the time census enumerators reached the upland hamlets of the fictional Corvane district in October 1911, most families _____ for the seasonal harvest camps, leaving the official population counts sharply and misleadingly low.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had already left
- B) have already left
- C) already leave
- D) will have left

Q21. [Hard]

In hydrology, "measured rainfall" and "modeled rainfall" are often treated as interchangeable, a convenience that conceals real gaps. In 2023, a team led by statistician Ruben Alcaraz built a framework to quantify those gaps. Reconciling the two quantities—whether over deserts, deltas, or icefields—_____ among the team's primary aims.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) was
- B) were
- C) being
- D) having been

Q22. [Hard]

Chef Amara Sy's renown as one of the boldest voices in West African _____ cemented by a string of acclaimed tasting menus in Dakar and Lyon, has at times eclipsed her scholarship on the history of Senegalese home cooking.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) cuisine,
- B) cuisine was
- C) cuisine had been
- D) cuisine, was

Q23. [Hard]

Now viewed as a conceptual ancestor of programmable textile machines, weaver Ines Halloran's 1911 workbook paired each pattern with a private shorthand. Though her prototype loom had limited output, the notation symbols sketched in the workbook—including a glyph that signaled an automatic color reversal—_____ a strikingly early vision of stored instructions.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) constitute
- B) constitutes
- C) constituting
- D) has constituted

Q24. [Hard]

Critics long read *Salt Meridian* (1968) and *The Ninth Tide* (1971) as unrelated memoirs. However, the parallels between the _____ childhoods—both narrators recount summers spent aboard their grandmothers' fishing trawlers—suggest that the two books form a deliberate literary conversation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) memoirs' narrators'
- B) memoir's narrator's
- C) memoirs' narrators
- D) memoir's narrators'

Q25. [Hard]

On March 3, 1911, the survey ship *Petrel Star* departed Ushuaia, Argentina, commencing Voyage _____ nine weeks and four days, the crossing ended when the ship reached Fremantle, Australia, with its hull sheathed in ice scars.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) K-17, it lasted
- B) K-17, lasting
- C) K-17 lasting
- D) K-17. Lasting

Q26. [Hard]

The murals of Valparaíso, Chile, may encode the city's economic geography. In a 2024 study, researchers examining connections between the neighborhood in which a mural was painted and _____ imagery analyzed more than 900 murals across the city. Murals in port-adjacent districts, they found, favored maritime motifs at triple the rate of hillside murals.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its
 - B) it's
 - C) their
 - D) they're
-

Q27. [Hard]

Working with village cooperatives between 2015 and 2022, engineer Kofi Danquah, organizer Efua Mensimah, and agronomist Lena Boateng installed microgrid training hubs as part of an effort to expand access to solar _____ but also across the wider Sahel.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) power—not only in Ghana—
- B) power not only in Ghana,
- C) power, not only in Ghana,
- D) power—not only in Ghana

Q28. [Hard]

Poet Deja Marchetti's 2018 collection *Saltglass* gathers forty-one poems written across a decade of coastal residencies. Marchetti's poem _____ appears midway through the collection and is often cited as its most formally daring piece, its lines splitting into twin columns that can be read in either order.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) "Gullwing"
- B) , "Gullwing,"
- C) "Gullwing,"
- D) , "Gullwing"

Q29. [Medium]

Weighing nearly a ton and coated in centuries of corrosion, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the researchers struggled for two days to move the bronze temple bell.
- B) the bronze temple bell resisted the researchers' efforts to move it for two days.
- C) moving the bronze temple bell challenged the researchers for two days.
- D) the researchers' two-day effort to move the bronze temple bell nearly failed.

Q30. [Medium]

In her 2020 analysis of the fictional port city of Anverre, economist Solveig Ridder attributes the district's recovery not to a single sweeping policy but _____ a series of small administrative reforms enacted quietly over fifteen years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) to
- B) for
- C) with
- D) by

Q31. [Easy]

Unlike most nocturnal pollinators, yucca moths do not sip _____ they visit the flowers solely to deposit eggs and, in the process, transfer pollen between blossoms.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) nectar, they
- B) nectar they
- C) nectar; they
- D) nectar; and they

Q32. [Easy]

Assembled over forty years by horticulturist Beata Lindqvist, the collection of vintage seed catalogs _____ now available online through the Millbrae Botanical Library.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) is
- B) are
- C) were
- D) have been

Q33. [Easy]

After a three-year structural retrofit, the Calverton Museum of Industry _____ its east wing to visitors next year with an exhibition on early refrigeration.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) will reopen
- B) reopened
- C) had reopened
- D) was reopening

Q34. [Easy]

Farmers in the fictional Drava Valley long consulted almanac writer Tobiah Krenz, who was renowned for _____ damaging hailstorms several days in advance by tracking subtle shifts in cloud color.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) predicting
 - B) predicts
 - C) predicted
 - D) to predict
-

Q35. [Easy]

The switchback trail up Mount Ferrow was cut entirely by hand in the 1930s by local volunteers, _____ worked in rotating crews of ten during the region's brief dry season.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) who
- B) whom
- C) which
- D) whose

Q36. [Easy]

Founded in 1921, the Larkspur Symphony performs in a converted rail depot whose acoustics musicians praise. The _____ rehearsal schedule, posted each August, is built around the depot's freight-era heating system, which warms the hall only by midmorning.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) orchestra's
- B) orchestras
- C) orchestras'
- D) orchestra

Q37. [Easy]

Although the Camarra Reef lies entirely within a patrolled marine _____ poaching of ornamental fish persists along its western edge, where patrol boats cannot navigate the shallow coral heads.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) reserve,
- B) reserve.
- C) reserve;
- D) reserve

Q38. [Easy]

Despite two decades of excavation at the hillfort site, there _____ several unresolved questions about how its builders transported timber across the surrounding bogland.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) remain
 - B) remains
 - C) is
 - D) was
-

Q39. [Easy]

In 1889, engineer Philomena Darrow designed a counterweighted canal lock for the fictional Brindle Cut and _____ a patent that described the mechanism in fourteen hand-in-inked diagrams.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) filed
- B) files
- C) will file
- D) is filing

Q40. [Medium]

Excavations at the lakeside settlement of Vodran yielded three classes of weaving _____ spindle whorls, clay loom weights, and finely toothed loom combs carved from antler.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) equipment:
- B) equipment;
- C) equipment,
- D) equipment

Q41. [Medium]

The pigment, a stable synthetic ultramarine first produced commercially in _____ transformed fresco restoration by allowing conservators to match medieval blues without mining lapis lazuli.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 1928,
- B) 1928—
- C) 1928;
- D) 1928.

Q42. [Medium]

Attribution of the studio's surviving works remains contested: neither the preparatory sketches nor the finished canvas _____ signed, and the workshop's ledgers list only materials, never artists.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) was
 - B) were
 - C) have been
 - D) are
-

Q43. [Medium]

Since opening in 2018, the Ostrava Ice Core Facility _____ more than 400 samples for laboratories on four continents, maintaining an unbroken storage temperature of -36°C throughout.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) has processed
- B) processed
- C) processes
- D) had processed

Q44. [Medium]

The archive's oldest chart, drawn on vellum and _____ in 1502 by two Genoese hands, shows a coastline annotated in a mixture of Latin and Ligurian dialect.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) annotated
- B) annotating
- C) annotates
- D) to annotate

Q45. [Medium]

After eleven weeks of public hearings on the proposed transit corridor, the zoning committee announced _____ unanimous decision at a session that lasted barely four minutes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its
- B) their
- C) it's
- D) whose

Q46. [Medium]

Each December, the _____ choir at the Fenwick Music School performs carols arranged by its own singers, all of them between the ages of eight and twelve.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) children's
- B) childrens'
- C) childrens
- D) children

Q47. [Medium]

After analyzing two decades of tide-gauge records from the harbor, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the seawall's design was revised by the port authority's engineers to add a curved deflector lip.
- B) the port authority's engineers revised the seawall's design to add a curved deflector lip.
- C) revisions adding a curved deflector lip were made to the seawall's design.
- D) the seawall's design underwent revision to add a curved deflector lip.

Q48. [Medium]

The independent audit credited the clinic network with lowering per-visit costs, expanding rural coverage, and _____ average wait times by nearly a third over five years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) reducing
- B) reduced
- C) to reduce
- D) it reduced

Q49. [Medium]

The Harrow Bend gristmill ceased commercial operation in _____ its oak waterwheel still turns every Saturday for demonstrations run by a volunteer millwright society.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 1962, but
- B) 1962 but
- C) 1962,
- D) 1962; but

Q50. [Medium]

The fisheries accord of 1948, _____ quota provisions quietly expired in 1970, is still cited in maritime law courses as a model of enforceable treaty language.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) whose
 - B) who's
 - C) which
 - D) that
-

Q51. [Medium]

The shipwreck's cargo hold had collapsed, yet the silt preserved its contents in place: among the recovered items _____ a bronze astrolabe and two waterlogged merchant ledgers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) were
- B) was
- C) is
- D) has been

Q52. [Hard]

In the greenhouse trials, the results were _____ every seedling grown under the spectrally filtered light outperformed its unfiltered control in both root mass and leaf area.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) unambiguous:
- B) unambiguous,
- C) unambiguous
- D) unambiguous and

Q53. [Hard]

To track how tidewater ice responds to warming fjord currents, glaciologist Maren Ostvik's team fixed time-lapse cameras above the fictional Skalvir Fjord. The glacier _____ the fjord's northern arm, which had retreated behind a submerged rock sill during the 1990s, calved bergs large enough to close the shipping lane for days.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) occupied
- B) was occupying
- C) occupying
- D) occupies

Q54. [Hard]

Aerospace designers prize the ceramic composite silvorine because it is one of the few structural materials that _____ tensile strength above 1,400°C, a threshold at which most alloys begin to slump.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) retain
- B) retains
- C) is retaining
- D) has retained

Q55. [Hard]

The restoration of the Quillon Street pumping station finally began in March, after three _____ delay caused by disputes over which era of the building's machinery deserved preservation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) years'
- B) years
- C) year's
- D) years's

Q56. [Hard]

Investigators concluded that the 1974 flood's damage to the county archive was avoidable: had the earthen levee been maintained to its original specifications, the water _____ the building's ground-floor stacks at all.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) would not have reached
- B) will not have reached
- C) had not reached
- D) would not reach

Q57. [Hard]

Between 1898 and 1911, master enameleer Sachiko Torii trained fourteen apprentices, several of _____ later opened studios of their own in Kanazawa and helped establish the region's reputation for translucent cloisonné.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) whom
 - B) who
 - C) which
 - D) them
-

Q58. [Hard]

Novelist Hetty Marlowe completed a single work of long fiction before abandoning literature for courtroom journalism. Marlowe's only novel, _____ was published posthumously in 1953 from a typescript her sister had preserved in a bank vault.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Cinder Road,
- B) Cinder Road
- C) Cinder Road;
- D) Cinder Road:

Q59. [Hard]

Media historian Priya Venkatesan argues that a familiar pattern is repeating: just as the printing press gradually standardized English spelling across regions, _____ streaming platforms are now standardizing pronunciation across dialects.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) so
- B) and
- C) therefore
- D) likewise

Q60. [Hard]

Conservators assessing the monastery's water-damaged library reported a sobering figure: nearly 40 percent of the recovered manuscripts _____ ink migration severe enough to obscure at least one full page of text.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) show
- B) shows
- C) is showing
- D) has shown

Q61. [Easy]

The greenhouse's automated vents open whenever the interior temperature climbs above a set _____ they close again once the air has cooled.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) threshold, and
- B) threshold and
- C) threshold, they
- D) threshold they

Q62. [Easy]

The archive of ferry timetables, gathered by a retired harbormaster over three decades, _____ a rare picture of how coastal travel shifted after the bridge opened.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) offers
- B) offer
- C) have offered
- D) are offering

Q63. [Easy]

The Nardo Glass Cooperative closed its furnaces in 1987, but a group of former apprentices _____ the workshop in 2009 and now trains a new generation of glassblowers there.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) reopened
- B) reopens
- C) will reopen
- D) is reopening

Q64. [Easy]

Sculptor Ravi Kulkarni is known for _____ discarded farm tools into towering figures that seem to stride across the fields where the metal was once used.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) transforming
 - B) transforms
 - C) transformed
 - D) to transform
-

Q65. [Easy]

Each of the five apprentice bakers at the Vellsholm bakery _____ responsible for a single stage of the morning's production, from mixing to final glazing.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) is
- B) are
- C) were
- D) have been

Q66. [Easy]

Because the manuscript's binding had grown too fragile to open, conservators photographed each page through a specially built cradle _____ held the covers at a shallow angle.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) that
- B) who
- C) whom
- D) what

Q67. [Easy]

The lighthouse keeper's logbooks, water-stained but legible, reveal a startling detail: for eleven consecutive winters, the beam _____ dimmed for exactly one hour each night.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) was
- B) were
- C) are
- D) have been

Q68. [Easy]

When did the practice of tuning instruments to a shared reference pitch become _____ answer involves a series of international conferences held over the nineteenth century.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) standard? The
- B) standard, the
- C) standard. The
- D) standard the

Q69. [Easy]

The city's oldest tram line, built in 1904 and restored in _____ carries commuters along the same riverfront route it served more than a century ago.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 2011,
- B) 2011;
- C) 2011:
- D) 2011

Q70. [Medium]

The report identified three obstacles to the reforestation _____ compacted soil, an absence of native seed stock, and browsing pressure from an overpopulation of deer.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) project:
- B) project;
- C) project,
- D) project

Q71. [Medium]

The coin, a silver denarius struck during a brief and turbulent _____ was unearthed beneath a former marketplace and has helped historians date the site's abandonment.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) reign,
- B) reign;
- C) reign:
- D) reign

Q72. [Medium]

Neither the field notebooks nor the annotated map _____ any indication of where the expedition's fourth camp had been established.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) provides
- B) provide
- C) have provided
- D) are providing

Q73. [Medium]

Since the observatory installed its adaptive-optics system in 2015, the number of confirmed exoplanet detections credited to the facility _____ more than tripled.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) has
- B) have
- C) are
- D) were

Q74. [Medium]

The tapestry, woven in the fifteenth century and _____ in the nineteenth, depicts a hunting scene whose colors have faded unevenly across its enormous width.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) repaired
- B) repairing
- C) repairs
- D) to repair

Q75. [Medium]

After the town council spent two years debating the fate of the derelict cannery, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) a decision to convert it into a public market was finally reached by the members.
- B) the members finally reached a decision to convert it into a public market.
- C) converting it into a public market was the decision finally reached.
- D) the derelict cannery's conversion into a public market was finally decided.

Q76. [Medium]

The grant will allow the museum to digitize its photographic negatives, catalog its uncataloged sculpture, and _____ climate control to its most vulnerable storage rooms.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) extend
 - B) extending
 - C) extended
 - D) extends
-

Q77. [Medium]

The observatory suspended public tours in _____ its aging dome mechanism had begun to jam, and repairs required the removal of scaffolding that blocked the visitor gallery.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 2019, for
- B) 2019 for
- C) 2019; for,
- D) 2019: for

Q78. [Medium]

The composer Livia Sernau, _____ early symphonies were dismissed as derivative, is now credited with pioneering the microtonal techniques that defined the following decade.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) whose
- B) who's
- C) who
- D) which

Q79. [Medium]

Preserved in the anaerobic mud of the bog for two millennia, the leather satchel and its contents _____ remarkably intact when a peat cutter uncovered them in 1954.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) were
- B) was
- C) is
- D) has been

Q80. [Medium]

The economist attributed the region's resilience not to a windfall of resources but _____ a diversified base of small manufacturers that could absorb shocks in any single sector.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) to
 - B) from
 - C) with
 - D) by
-

Q81. [Hard]

The excavation records were finally _____ every artifact had been logged with a photograph, a grid coordinate, and a stratigraphic layer number, allowing later researchers to reconstruct the dig with confidence.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) complete:
- B) complete,
- C) complete
- D) complete and

Q82. [Hard]

To measure how urban canopy loss affects summer heat, climatologist Idris Fanaka's team mounted sensors along a transect of city blocks. The neighborhood _____ the transect's eastern end, which had lost nearly half its street trees to a decade of construction, recorded nighttime temperatures four degrees higher than the leafy blocks to the west.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) anchoring
- B) anchored
- C) anchors
- D) had anchored

Q83. [Hard]

Metallurgists value the alloy dravantium because it is one of the few casting materials that _____ almost no shrinkage as it cools, a property prized for producing precise, gap-free molds.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) exhibit
 - B) exhibits
 - C) is exhibiting
 - D) has exhibited
-

Q84. [Hard]

The renovation of the concert hall was delayed by nearly four _____ dispute over whether the original horsehair plaster, prized for its acoustics, could be legally replaced with a modern equivalent.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) months'
- B) months
- C) month's
- D) months's

Q85. [Hard]

Archivists concluded that the ledger's water damage had been preventable: had the basement's sump pump been serviced on schedule, the floodwater _____ the shelving where the oldest volumes were stored.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) would never have reached
- B) will never have reached
- C) had never reached
- D) would never reach

Q86. [Hard]

Over a fourteen-year correspondence, botanist Cornelia Ashby exchanged specimens with dozens of collectors, many of _____ she never met in person yet regarded as her closest scientific colleagues.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) whom
- B) who
- C) which
- D) them

Q87. [Hard]

Playwright Delano Sarr completed only one work for the stage before turning to film criticism. Sarr's sole play, _____ was revived in 1998 by a company determined to rescue it from obscurity, and the production ran for two sold-out seasons.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) The Ferryman's Wager,
- B) The Ferryman's Wager
- C) The Ferryman's Wager;
- D) The Ferryman's Wager:

Q88. [Hard]

Linguist Marisol Ekwe contends that a familiar dynamic is recurring: just as radio once accelerated the spread of standardized broadcast accents, _____ short-form video is now accelerating the spread of a handful of dominant speech patterns among young speakers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) so
- B) and
- C) thus
- D) similarly

Q89. [Hard]

A survey of the flooded riverside district produced a grim statistic: nearly a third of the surveyed _____ structural damage severe enough to require demolition rather than repair.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) buildings had sustained
- B) buildings has sustained
- C) building had sustained
- D) buildings, having sustained

Q90. [Hard]

The essayist's late work is often misread as a retreat into nostalgia; _____ close attention to its imagery reveals a sustained, unsentimental argument about the costs of technological progress.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) however,
- B) therefore,
- C) likewise,
- D) for example,

Q91. [Easy]

Freight barges no longer use the Brindle _____ now draws kayakers, anglers, and a summer procession of tour boats narrating its towpath history.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Canal, which
- B) Canal. Which
- C) Canal; which
- D) Canal which

Q92. [Easy]

The dosage instructions on the medication's outer label _____ deliberately printed in three languages and in a typeface tested for readability in low light.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) are
- B) is
- C) was
- D) has been

Q93. [Easy]

During the 1930s, the coastal radio station at Pellam Head _____ nightly forecasts that fishing crews across the strait planned their departures around.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) broadcast
- B) broadcasts
- C) will broadcast
- D) is broadcasting

Q94. [Easy]

According to the trial protocol, the vaccine must _____ stored below -60°C from the moment of manufacture until minutes before injection.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) be
- B) been
- C) being
- D) is

Q95. [Easy]

Working from opposite ends of the wall, the twin muralists finished _____ hundred-meter painting in nineteen days, meeting precisely at the harbor gate.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) their
 - B) there
 - C) they're
 - D) theirs
-

Q96. [Easy]

Vinyl record sales in the fictional Averil Isles peaked in the _____ before cassette players installed in fishing boats reshaped how islanders bought music.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 1970s
- B) 1970's
- C) 1970s'
- D) 1970

Q97. [Easy]

By the end of the nineteenth _____ the practice of paying lighthouse keepers partly in lamp oil had vanished from every station on the coast.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) century,
- B) century;
- C) century.
- D) century

Q98. [Easy]

Among the volunteers who restored the tide mill, there _____ little doubt that the machinery's survival owed everything to the thick coat of lanolin applied before the war.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) was
- B) were
- C) are
- D) have been

Q99. [Easy]

The Marlowe Street choir has _____ the same processional anthem on the first Sunday of spring for nearly seventy years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) sung
 - B) sang
 - C) sing
 - D) singing
-

Q100. [Medium]

The footbridge passed its annual load _____ however, engineers flagged corrosion in two anchor plates and scheduled their replacement for the autumn.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) inspection;
- B) inspection,
- C) inspection
- D) inspection:

Q101. [Medium]

The documentary's director, as well as its two producers, _____ attending the festival screening to answer questions about the film's decade-long production.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) is
- B) are
- C) were
- D) have been

Q102. [Medium]

Rosa Calvette's 1962 novel *The Longest Ferry* ends where it began: in the final chapter, the narrator _____ to the island of her childhood and finds the ferry schedule unchanged after thirty years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) returns
- B) returned
- C) will return
- D) had returned

Q103. [Medium]

Entomologist Priya Raghunathan spent the summer of 2021 _____ beetle specimens from a single fallen oak, ultimately identifying 240 species living within one trunk.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) cataloging
 - B) catalog
 - C) to catalog
 - D) cataloged
-

Q104. [Medium]

The reading-room rules are strict: if one wishes to consult the medieval charters, _____ must register a week in advance and handle the documents only with the tools provided.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) one
- B) you
- C) they
- D) we

Q105. [Medium]

Every autumn, the Rivera family hosts the entire block at a long table set up in the alley; neighbors mark their calendars months ahead for the _____ harvest dinner.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Riveras'
- B) Rivera's
- C) Riveras
- D) Riveras's

Q106. [Medium]

Hoping to attract migrating warblers to the schoolyard, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) native berry shrubs were planted along the fence line by the volunteers.
- B) the volunteers planted native berry shrubs along the fence line.
- C) the planting of native berry shrubs along the fence line began in March.
- D) native berry shrubs replaced the ornamental hedge along the fence line.

Q107. [Medium]

Facing a repair estimate larger than its annual budget, the parish council voted to either restore the pipe organ in place or _____ it to a museum with the resources to maintain it.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) donate
- B) donating
- C) donated
- D) to donate

Q108. [Medium]

At the Vessing pottery workshop, apprentices learned one rule before any _____ the kiln door stays shut until the count of two hundred, no matter what sounds come from inside.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) other:
- B) other,
- C) other
- D) other and

Q109. [Medium]

Everyone in the three villages along the Corvel River _____ invited to the bridge's reopening, and nearly two thousand people crossed it on foot that first morning.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) was
- B) were
- C) are
- D) have been

Q110. [Medium]

In 1957, the new dam created a reservoir _____ submerged the old post road, forcing mail carriers onto a mountain route that added a day to every delivery.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) that
- B) whom
- C) , it
- D) , this

Q111. [Medium]

By 1900, the fictional Corvane telegraph network _____ to forty stations, linking mining camps that had been reachable only by mule track a decade earlier.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had grown
 - B) has grown
 - C) grows
 - D) will have grown
-

Q112. [Hard]

Delegates to the 1911 congress on port sanitation traveled from Osaka, _____ and Porto, Portugal, making it the first such gathering with representatives from three continents.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Japan; Gdańsk, Poland;
- B) Japan, Gdańsk, Poland,
- C) Japan; Gdańsk; Poland;
- D) Japan, Gdańsk; Poland,

Q113. [Hard]

The merger left the firm with two incompatible accounting systems, one inherited from each predecessor. To reconcile the two ledgers—line by line, across seventeen years of entries—_____ the auditors' first and most tedious task.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) was
- B) were
- C) being
- D) having been

Q114. [Hard]

Three rivers—the Sarn, the Vell, and the _____ converge in a braided delta below the citadel, and the city's oldest maps are essentially attempts to fix their wandering channels on paper.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Odra—
- B) Odra,
- C) Odra;
- D) Odra:

Q115. [Hard]

Before the telegraph reached the archipelago, each of the coastal colonies maintained _____ own signal tower, relaying storm warnings island to island with flags by day and lamps by night.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its
 - B) their
 - C) it's
 - D) there
-

Q116. [Hard]

At the close of the 1907 session, the interior minister announced that the long-postponed land census _____ the following spring, beginning with the river provinces where boundary disputes were most frequent.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) would begin
- B) will begin
- C) begins
- D) had begun

Q117. [Hard]

Foundry records explain why the alloy fell out of use despite its durability: its melting point exceeds _____ of bronze by more than 400 degrees, demanding furnaces few workshops could afford to run.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) that
- B) those
- C) the one
- D) it

Q118. [Hard]

At 3:14 a.m. on June 8, seismographs at the Kolvane volcano observatory registered the first pulse of a harmonic swarm, and technicians began logging Sequence _____ eleven minutes, the swarm ended as abruptly as it had begun.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) V-9, it lasted
- B) V-9, lasting
- C) V-9 lasting
- D) V-9. Lasting

Q119. [Hard]

Though the Tessary tablets record little beyond grain tallies, the marginal symbols pressed into their edges—among them a recurring sign that scholars read as denoting an eclipse—_____ evidence of far more systematic record keeping than the tallies alone suggest.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) offer
- B) offers
- C) offering
- D) has offered

Q120. [Hard]

Marine biologist Adaeze Ndiaye and acoustician Tomas Sorel spent eleven years recording reef soundscapes together. The findings of _____ decade-long collaboration upended assumptions about how larval fish locate coral to settle on.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Ndiaye and Sorel's
- B) Ndiaye's and Sorel's
- C) Ndiaye and Sorels'
- D) Ndiaye's and Sorel

Q121. [Easy]

Although the satellite's primary camera failed just three months into the _____ the secondary instrument captured enough data to salvage the mission's core objectives.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) mission,
- B) mission.
- C) mission;
- D) mission

Q122. [Easy]

The samples from the two deepest boreholes _____ a chemical signature consistent with volcanic ash, supporting the theory that the valley's clay layer originated from a distant eruption.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) exhibit
- B) exhibits
- C) is exhibiting
- D) has exhibited

Q123. [Easy]

Every August, the community potters of Salla Village _____ their kilns for the annual firing, a week-long event that draws buyers from across the province.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) prepare
- B) prepared
- C) will have prepared
- D) preparing

Q124. [Easy]

Faced with a crumbling seawall, the harbor commission hired structural engineers _____ the foundation and recommend the least disruptive repair method.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) to assess
- B) assessing
- C) assessed
- D) assess

Q125. [Easy]

The survey vessel towed a magnetometer, a device _____ detects buried iron by measuring disturbances in the Earth's magnetic field.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) that
- B) who
- C) whom
- D) whose

Q126. [Easy]

After the flood receded, one _____ mudroom still contained a shelf of undamaged preserves, a small miracle that the family credited to the room's unusually tight door seal.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) family's
- B) families
- C) families'
- D) familys'

Q127. [Easy]

The harbor's original lighthouse was dismantled in _____ a solar-powered beacon on a steel frame now marks the channel instead.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 1978.
- B) 1978,
- C) 1978
- D) 1978:

Q128. [Easy]

Inside the archive's humidity-controlled vault, there _____ a single drawer dedicated entirely to correspondence between the colony's first governor and the admiralty in London.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) is
- B) are
- C) were
- D) have been

Q129. [Easy]

Since 1971, the Åland Maritime Museum has _____ a restored pilot cutter out of its boathouse every summer for visitors to board and explore.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) brought
- B) bring
- C) bringing
- D) brung

Q130. [Medium]

The reason the Hollister Reef dive site attracts so few recreational _____ its currents reverse unpredictably, and even experienced divers have been swept past the drop-off.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) divers is simple:
- B) divers, is simple,
- C) divers is simple
- D) divers is simple;

Q131. [Medium]

The canopy bridge, designed by wildlife ecologist Maura Goss and suspended across the motorway in _____ allows arboreal mammals to cross without descending to ground level.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) 2016,
- B) 2016;
- C) 2016:
- D) 2016

Q132. [Medium]

A number of regional museums _____ begun offering free admission on the first Saturday of each month, a policy that curators credit with doubling weekend foot traffic.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) have
- B) has
- C) is
- D) was

Q133. [Medium]

Over the past decade, the concentration of dissolved nitrogen in the Felmark aquifer _____ steadily, prompting regulators to tighten fertilizer limits for farms above the recharge zone.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) has risen
- B) rose
- C) rises
- D) had risen

Q134. [Medium]

The city council praised the new transit hub as spacious, energy-efficient, and _____ to the surrounding residential blocks.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) sympathetic in its design
 - B) its design is sympathetic
 - C) it has a sympathetic design
 - D) with a sympathetic design
-

Q135. [Medium]

Noticing hairline fractures along the hull's waterline, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) an immediate dry-dock inspection was ordered by the surveyor.
- B) the surveyor ordered an immediate dry-dock inspection.
- C) an immediate dry-dock inspection became the surveyor's priority.
- D) the decision was made to order an immediate dry-dock inspection.

Q136. [Medium]

The lab's electron microscope, _____ can magnify structures up to 500,000 times, was donated by a pharmaceutical firm that had upgraded to a newer model.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) which
- B) that
- C) it
- D) and it

Q137. [Medium]

The pottery workshop sets aside one Saturday a month for a _____ glazing class, in which participants shape and fire their own bowls.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) women's
- B) womens'
- C) womens
- D) women

Q138. [Medium]

The dredger cleared the harbor mouth by early _____ the first cargo vessel entered the newly deepened channel later that same afternoon.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) morning;
- B) morning,
- C) morning
- D) morning, the

Q139. [Medium]

The review board recommended that the university _____ its data-retention policy before the start of the fall semester to comply with the updated privacy regulations.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) revise
- B) revises
- C) revised
- D) will revise

Q140. [Medium]

Every stone in the monastery wall _____ cut from a single nearby quarry, a fact confirmed by geochemical analysis of the morite inclusions in the rock.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) was
- B) were
- C) are
- D) have been

Q141. [Medium]

The fellowship provides recipients with a monthly stipend, access to specialized laboratory equipment, and _____ from senior researchers in the fellow's chosen discipline.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) mentorship
- B) mentored
- C) to be mentored
- D) mentoring them

Q142. [Hard]

When performing Carnatic music, vocalists do not simply follow the written _____ they ornament each phrase with microtonal inflections drawn from a shared but unnotated tradition.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) notation, rather,
- B) notation; rather,
- C) notation, rather;
- D) notation, rather

Q143. [Hard]

In astrophysics, distinguishing short gamma-ray bursts from long ones—whether emitted by neutron-star mergers, collapsing stars, or magnetar flares—_____ among the field's most debated classification problems.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) remains
- B) remain
- C) remaining
- D) have remained

Q144. [Hard]

Scholars have long debated the intended audience of the two _____ opening chapters; one narrative addresses an unnamed patron while the other seems directed at the general reading public.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) manuscripts' respective
- B) manuscript's respective
- C) manuscripts respective
- D) manuscripts's respective

Q145. [Hard]

By the time the replacement pump arrived at the flooded mine in March, the water level _____ so high that crews needed an additional week just to make the tunnels accessible.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had risen
- B) has risen
- C) rises
- D) will have risen

Q146. [Hard]

To determine how drought alters soil microbiology, ecologist Ingrid Solheim's team collected weekly core samples from a test field. The plot _____ the field's driest quadrant, which had received no supplemental water since the previous autumn, yielded microbial communities strikingly different from those found in irrigated zones.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) comprising
- B) comprised
- C) comprises
- D) had comprised

Q147. [Hard]

The apprentice _____ the guild master selected for the commission had trained under three different ceramicists before arriving at the workshop, an unusual breadth of experience for someone so early in a career.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) whom
- B) who
- C) which
- D) whose

Q148. [Hard]

Two genera of deep-sea worms—*Osedax*, which consumes whale bone, and *Lamellibrachia*, which thrives at hydrocarbon _____ challenge the conventional image of the ocean floor as a barren environment.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) seeps—
- B) seeps,
- C) seeps;
- D) seeps

Q149. [Hard]

The conclusion drawn by the panel was _____ the levee system's original designers had accounted for storm surge but not for the sustained fluvial flooding that caused the 2018 breach.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) sobering:
- B) sobering,
- C) sobering
- D) sobering; that

Q150. [Hard]

Theater historian Maren Aldiss's comprehensive study of the Globe Playhouse reveals that a single carpenter, Elias Poole, built most of the _____ trapdoors and stage machinery, yet not one of his contracts survives in the municipal record, a gap Aldiss attributes to the deliberate destruction of theatrical archives during the Interregnum.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) theater's
- B) theaters
- C) theaters'
- D) theater